

CLUE & CANDLE GAMES PRESENTS

START HERE

The **Thistledown** *Supper*

A Cozy Dinner Party Murder Mystery

4-8 PLAYERS

2-2.5 HOURS

PRINTABLE PDF

Read this file first, on screen. It tells you what every file is for, who may see it, and exactly what to print for 4, 5, 6, 7 or 8 players.



Read Me First

HOST · 5 MINUTES

You downloaded two identical folders, **US-Letter** and **A4**. The files and contents are the same; only the paper size differs. Print from the folder that matches your paper.

FILE	WHAT IT IS	WHO SEES IT
00 START-HERE	This guide: files, player counts, print list, FAQ	Host, on screen
01 Host-Guide	Checklist, casting, timelines, Scripts 1–4, menu, tips. No spoilers.	Host
02 Invitations	8 character invitations, a blank-name invitation, text to email	Each guest gets their own
03 Cast-List	Public who’s who of all 8 characters and Barty	Everyone
10–17 Booklet-...	One 4-page booklet per character (10–13 core, 14–17 optional)	Each player, only their own
18 All-Booklets-Combined	The same 8 booklets in one file for one-click printing	Print it, don’t read it
30 Evidence-Cards	9 evidence cards (E1–E9), 3 blank cards, card backs	The table, round by round
31 Name-Tags-and-Place-Cards	12 name tags, 8 folding place cards	Everyone
32 Accusation-Ballots	4 ballots per page, with scoring	Everyone, after dessert
33 Detective-Notes	Suspect grid and a 5:00–8:00 pm timeline	One per player
34 Menu-and-Table-Cards	Menu card, 2 table signs, 2 award certificates	Optional decor
99 SOLUTION-Open-Last	The answer, the clue chain and the final reveal script	Nobody until after the vote

DO NOT OPEN FILE 99

You never need the answer to run this game, so you can play and guess along with everyone else. Print 99 last without reading it, seal it in an envelope marked “Open after the vote,” and let any player open it after the ballots are in.

PRINT THE BOOKLETS SINGLE-SIDED

Each booklet is 4 pages; single-sided, later rounds can’t show through. On page 3, players fold Round 2 away on the dashed line until the main course.

Who plays which booklet

PLAYERS	BOOKLETS TO HAND OUT	CHARACTERS
4	10, 11, 12, 13	Rowan, Ellis, Morgan, Sage (the four core characters)
5	10–14	core four + Harper
6	10–15	core four + Harper, Quinn
7	10–16	core four + Harper, Quinn, Avery
8	10–17	all eight

The host plays too: take booklet 10 or 11 for yourself and hand out the rest. The full case can be solved with the four core booklets and the nine evidence cards, so a party of four gets the complete mystery.

Print list (pages to print)

PLAYERS	01	03	BOOKLETS	30	31	32 BALLOTS	33 NOTES	99	TOTAL
4	12	2	10–13: 4×4 = 16	3	2	1 × 1 copy = 1	1 × 4 = 4	5	45
5	12	2	10–14: 5×4 = 20	3	2	1 × 2 copies = 2	1 × 5 = 5	5	51
6	12	2	10–15: 6×4 = 24	3	2	1 × 2 copies = 2	1 × 6 = 6	5	56
7	12	2	10–16: 7×4 = 28	3	2	1 × 2 copies = 2	1 × 7 = 7	5	61
8	12	2	10–17: 8×4 = 32	3	2	1 × 2 copies = 2	1 × 8 = 8	5	66

Every total = 01 Host Guide (12 pages) + 03 Cast List (2) + the booklets (4 pages each) + 30 Evidence Cards (3) + 31 Name Tags and Place Cards (2) + 32 Ballots (1 page, 4 ballots, printed once or twice) + 33 Detective Notes (1 page per player) + 99 Solution (5).

OPTIONAL (NOT IN THE TOTALS)
00 Start Here (4 pages, read on screen) · 02 Invitations (6 pages) · 34 Menu and Table Cards (3 pages). File 18 (32 pages) holds the same 8 booklets as files 10–17: print one or the other, never both.

PRINTER SETTINGS
Print at 100% (“Actual size”), not “Fit to page.” Black-and-white is fine: every word, frame and cut line stays clear in grayscale. Plain paper works; card stock is nice for name tags and place cards.

Questions Before You Start

Can the host play?

Yes. The Host Guide contains no spoilers, and the answer is sealed in file 99, which a player opens only after everyone has voted. You take a character booklet and guess along with your guests.

How much reading is there?

Each booklet is 4 pages. Page 2 is read alone before the party, and each round's section is under 180 words, about a minute's reading per course.

Will it print well in black and white?

Yes. Text is near-black on a light page, and every frame, fill line and cut line is dark enough for a home printer in grayscale.

We are only four. Does it still work?

Yes. The four core characters and the nine evidence cards hold the complete clue trail. Characters 5–8 add color, extra suspects and red herrings, but the case never depends on them.

Is it OK for teens and grandparents?

Yes. It is a cozy, PG mystery with nothing gruesome: Barty simply falls asleep and never wakes. No romance, no swearing and no drinking tasks; the cordial can be any soft drink.

Do the roles work for any gender?

Yes. All eight names are gender-neutral and the booklets refer to characters by name, so anyone can play anyone.

NEED HELP?

Email hello@clueandcandlegames.com. If the game doesn't work for your party, ask for a refund within 14 days of purchase.

A NOTE ON HOW THIS GAME WAS MADE

The Thistledown Supper is an original story. It was written with the help of AI writing tools, then edited, checked step by step for fair-play logic and laid out by the Clue & Candle Games team. Thistledown House, Fernley and every character are fictional.



Enjoy your supper, and trust no one who refuses dessert.